

HomeStation: The Xbox Alternative

There's a new alternative for Xbox on the anvil, if unofficial sources are to be believed. Some sources have claimed that Microsoft is putting the finishing touches on its next home entertainment product: a more multimedia, less games-oriented alternative to Xbox.

This Xbox alternative/successor, will be based on nVidia's nForce chipset and Intel's Pentium 4 processor. Tentatively dubbed the HomeStation, it would serve as a

home entertainment hub pulling in content from the Internet, DVD and TV. The box is also said to incorporate the ability to record regular TV programming.

Initially similar functionality was planned for the Xbox, but it looks like Microsoft may have decided to incorporate them into a second machine. The company is said to be waiting for a much wider availability of broadband connections before releasing the new system.

quicktake

Can FreeMarkets save you money?

▲ What's FreeMarkets?

FreeMarkets is the leading global sourcing market and provider of e-sourcing software and service solutions. Through its unique combination of Web-based software, supply market information, market operations and sourcing services, FreeMarkets has helped customers



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date, we have delivered over \$4 billion in cost savings to our customers.

Our customers save 5-25 per cent on purchase contracts while typically achieving an ROI of 500 per cent in the first year itself! This is facilitated by our five-step Market-Making process, which is designed to help you identify, execute and realise real and tangible cost-savings.

▲ What is your USP?

FreeMarkets' USP remains its ability to offer a 'high ROI' in a short period of time without the pain of implementing long-gestation technology solutions.

▲ What about the Indian market?

1,500 Indian suppliers are registered with us and active in our global sourcing market, and we have delivered over \$4 billion in cost savings to our customers.

▲ How will a user benefit from FreeMarkets?

FreeMarkets delivers cost savings to its customers (buyers) who e-source with us. Till

Redalert

W32.Nimda.A@mm

Mail@admin all

Known as 'Nimda', which spells admin backwards, this mass mailing worm has been spreading like wildfire across the Internet.

W32.Nimda.A@mm is a new worm that uses several different methods to spread and infects systems running Microsoft Windows 95, 98, Me, NT and 2000. The worm can come to you via e-mail, or through an open network share. It also attempts to copy itself to vulnerable Microsoft IIS web servers and infects both local and shared network files. The fact that Nimda attacks using a combination of methods and affects both PCs and servers makes it pretty unique. You can avoid being infected by disabling Java script on your machine and avoiding opening any unfamiliar e-mails.

Microsoft has made a patch available for IE 5.xx users which can be downloaded from

<http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/bulletin/ms00-078.asp>

W32.Magistr.39921@mm

Lethal weapon

A variant of W32.Magistr.24876@mm, it overwrites Ntldr.exe and Win.com on all drives with code that causes it to store garbage data in the first sector of the first IDE hard drive. The virus/worm uses e-mail addresses from the Windows and Eudora Address Book files, Outlook Express Sent Items folder, and Netscape Sent Items files. The payload is lethal—it overwrites hard drives, erases CMOS, flashes the BIOS. The e-mail comes with randomly generated text and randomly named infected executables or document files. To remove this worm, use an updated antivirus software and delete all files that are detected as W32.Magistr.39921@mm. If necessary, restore any W32.Magistr.39921@mm infected files from a clean backup.

All new Radeon checks in

ATI, one of the leading graphics card manufacturers in the world has introduced

the Radeon 7500 and the Radeon 8500 cards will make use of the new Microsoft DirectX 8.1 API. New technology that has been incorporated

includes TRU-FORM, which is a rendering technology that will generate smoother, more natural 3D images.

Encouraged by the reasonable success of the original Radeon, ATI is aiming the



two new products that use its second-generation Radeon processor. Both

new Radeon cards directly at nVidia's top-of-the-line GeForce 3 based cards. →